Lebanese Arabic Phrasebook Vol. 2

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DEDICATION

While living in Beirut, I have had the chance to meet a lot of foreigners who visit the country each for their own different purpose. Many of them were struggling with the language, since the Fusha, which they had made a lot effort to learning, didn't seem to help, despite being an extremely eloquent modern standard language that unites all Arabic speaking countries. The reason for that struggle is that every Arab country has its own dialect that differs from Fusha.

If your destination is Lebanon, then I recommend this book that will provide you enough confidence and skills to converse with locals. I dedicate my book to my language and to everyone who is willing to learn it, and above all to the love of my country,a peculiar love, i must admit, for a place that is hard to live in but also harder to leave.

CONTENTS

PREFACE vi

INTRODUCTION 1

CHAPTER 1: BASIC LANGUAGE 7
CLOCK 7
INTERROGATIVE WORDS 12

CHAPTER 2: CONJUGATION 16
TO LOVE 16
TO TRAVEL 21

CHAPTER 3: AT HOME 26
INSIDE THE HOUSE 26
ORDERING FOOD 31
WINTER 36

CHAPTER 4: WORK AND STUDYING 39
STUDYING 39
JOBS 42

CHAPTER 5: BODY AND DOCTORS 45
BODY 45
DOCTOR 50

CHAPTER 6: POLITICS 54
PART 1 54
PART 2 58

CHAPTER 7: FORMALITIES 60
AT THE DOOR 60
MANNERS 63

CHAPTER 8: MISCELLANEOUS 68
WORLD CUP 69

CHAPTER 9: TEXTS 72
PRESENT TENSE 72
PAST TENSE 75
FUTURE TENSE 76

CHAPTER 10: EXERCISES 80
CHAPTER 11: EXTRA 85
PRESENT TENSE 86
PAST TENSE 87
FUTURE TENSE 88
STATE VERBS 89
VERB TO SEE 90
TIPS 91

CONCLUSION 93

ABOUT THE AUTHOR 96

PREFACE

So yes, I'm still here in Beirut, Lebanon. Asking myself everyday whether I should stay or leave in this corrupt country where we often find ourselves struggling to find a bit of happiness and something close to peace. Beirut is getting even more crowded, and to think that we never thought it possible! From poor public transportation, to lack of green spaces and of course the never-ending waste crisis that sadly no authority is trying to solve, one would wonder what makes so many remain here.

Putting aside all of the above, there still are some very convincing reasons to stay! I simply cannot imagine my days passing without seeing my family, friends, my wonderfully moderate summer-like winter, my happy hours in Badaro or Gemayze, or my road trips to our beautiful villages. With all the new positive vibes growing stronger, I still have high hopes in Lebanon, I believe in change, in the new generation that is willing to create, read, plant, or even recycle in the hope of creating more sustainable living conditions in this nation that is yet to model its true identity.

Having said this, I really want to thank you for following me on my YouTube channel that is celebrating its sixth year by now. Thank you for believing in a better Lebanon just like me. Thank you for coming back, for visiting, for finding your Lebanese roots, for teaching your children and also grand children your original dialect, thank you for your curiosity in a culture that you've grown up in or just heard about.

Thus, I dedicate this second book to all the good reasons that make me happy to stay here.

Wishing for peace and peace only, salam

سلام

INTRODUCTION

The following introduction is also present in the previous volume. It mainly lays out the method and guidelines that will be used throughout the book. If you already own Vol. 1 you probably have read this and already understand how it works. If not, I recommend you go through it because it will make reading the translations and transliterations much easier.

The method of teaching is vaguely inspired by the Rosetta Stone method that teaches the dialect through using practical sentences instead of memorizing strict grammatical rules.
All the words and phrases are transcribed from the videos, so there will be a reference to the relevant video below each sentence. You will be able to hear the correct pronunciation in order to master your accent and find detailed explanations of each word in complex phrases.
The sentences will be divided into themes like "Introductions" or "Traveling" and they will be written in 3 forms:

1. In English first.
2. Then in Lebanese transliteration (Latin alphabet) for

people who can't read Arabic.

3. And eventually in Lebanese (Arabic alphabet) for those who are Arabic literate.

Transliteration Guidelines

Since the Arabic alphabet is quite different from the Latin one that does not include the same letters, we'll have to agree upon certain rules that we'll use throughout the book as to avoid any confusion. The representations chosen will be based on their simplicity in contrast with the academic but more complex symbols such as [ʔ] or (ħ). There will be a table presenting each letter and its transliterated representation, preceded by an explanation of some of the letters used. While the table might only be useful for Arabic readers, the explanation will help all readers to recognize the sounds of the transliteration. If any of the following information seems too complicated for you, don't worry, you will find it to be simpler as you go along and read the actual words and phrases. These are just guidelines you can refer to if you find any difficulty in reading transliterations:

1. The Hamza (ء) which is a glottal stop, is not a full letter and is not one of the 28 letters of the alphabet but it is widely used in the language and especially in the Lebanese dialect, as in most Lebanese areas, the Qaf (ق) (pronounced as a "K" or a "Q" in standard Arabic) is pronounced as a Hamza and labeled as a glottal stop. The Hamza is phonetically represented as /ʔ/ while academically represented as a "modifier letter right half ring" (ʾ) which will be replaced by an apostrophe in this book (ʿ). You might find it to be represented with the number (2) on the web, as this is the conventional chatting representation of it, inspired by the inverted similarity in shape of the (2) and the (ء).

2. The Aleph (ا), the first letter of the Arabic alphabet, takes many forms, depending on its accentuation and on the placement of the Hamza in relation to it, facts that change the way it sounds. It might sound as a glottal stop or as a long vowel. For this reason, in cases where it sounds as a glottal stop it will be transliterated as a simple Hamza (ʿ) and in cases where it sounds like a vowel, it will be represented with the

respective vowels (a), (e), (i), (o), or (ei). The latter, (ei), is used as the sound of the accentuated letter (é).

3. Thaa' (ث), is an Arabic letter that sounds like (th) in English words like (th)ink or ba(th), but in the Lebanese dialect it is most commonly replaced by either a (t) or an (s) sound. So it might be written in words as a (ث), but pronounced as is written in the Transliteration. (Ex: Snow=Talej= ثلج)

4. The Arabic letter (ع) or Ayn has no similar letters or sounds in the Latin alphabet. It is articulated with the back of the throat and the root of the tongue. It is phonetically represented as /ʕ/, while its academic representation is the "modifier letter left half ring" (ʿ) which is similar to the representation of the Hamza. In order to avoid any confusion between the Hamza and the Ayn, the latter will be represented as it is in chatting forums with the number (3) because of its mirrored resemblance to (ع), letter "3ayn".

5. Ghayn (غ) is a variant of 3ayn (ع) in shape but is different in sound. The closest popular equivalent to its sound is the Parisian French (r). It is phonetically represented as /ɣ/ but most commonly transliterated as (gh) which we will use throughout the book.

6. The Haa' (ح) which is similar to the 3ayn in articulation (with the back of the throat and the root of the tongue) but different in phonation is represented phonetically as /ħ/ and academically as (ḥ) while in this book it will be represented as a capital (H) which is usually the simplest symbol of the Haa'. You might find that it is sometimes written as a (7) because of the number's resemblance to the upper part of (ح).

7. The Khaa' (خ) is pronounced in a way that is very similar to German, Scottish, and Polish (ch), Russian (x), and Spanish (j). It is phonetically represented as /x/, while its most common transliteration is (kh) which is used almost everywhere and is therefore used in this book. You might also find it to be represented as (5) which also resembles a distort-

ed mirrored (خ) missing the dot.

8. Thaal (ذ) and Thahh (ظ) which are variants of each other, and resemble the sound of the English (th) in (th)is or fea(th)er, are most commonly replaced by either a (d) or a (z). Ex: Memory=Zeikra= ذاكرة)

9. Finally, some words end with the sound (é), or might have this sound in the middle of the word. These will be transliterated as (eh) in the end, and (ei) in the middle.

As for the Lebanese words written in the Arabic alphabet, words ending with the (a) sound in Lebanese will be written:

1. as (ا) whenever the same word in Modern Standard Arabic end with (اء) or (مَا) like حَمراء or عَندها, written as حَمرا or عَندا

2. as (ة) whenever the word is feminine and has a masculine version, like رايحة

3. otherwise, they will be seen as (ه)

The Arabic Letters and Their Transliteration According To the Lebanese Dialect

ا	a|i|o|e|ei
ب	b
ت	t
ث	t|s
ج	j
ح	H
خ	kh
د	d
ذ	d|z
ر	r
ز	z
س	s
ش	sh
ص	s
ض	d

ط	t
ظ	d|z
ع	3
غ	gh
ف	f
ق	‘
ك	k
ل	l
م	m
ن	n
ه	h
و	w|ou
ي	i|y

CHAPTER 1: BASIC LANGUAGE

Basic: the word basic means "aseis" in Lebanese. It could be used to say we are in the first stage of building the home, we are building the aseis.

An additional meaning would be "it wasn't meant to be in the first place": bil aseis (or aseisan), ma kenit zabta

Aseiseh on the other hand can be used to ask: is it something really important? Houwe chi hal'ad aseiseh?

Songs: kifak enta, Feyrouz (wait till she says enta el asasi/ aseiseh w bHebbak bil asas/aseis)

CLOCK

Time	wa'et
	وَقت
Timing	touw'eet
	توقيت

Hour	sei3a ساعَة
2 hours	se3tein ساعتين
Hours	se3at ساعات
Minute	d'i'a دقيقَة
2 minutes	d'i'tein دقيقتين
Minutes	da'eyi' دَقايق
Second	seinyeh ثانية
2 seconds	senitein ثانتين
Seconds	saweineh ثواني
A.M	abel el doher قَبل الضُهر

P.M	ba3ed el doher بَعد الضُهر
It's late	m'akhar مأخَّر
It's early	bakkeer بكّير
What time is it?	addeh el sei3a? أدّي الساعَة؟
10 to 1	weHdeh 'ella 3ashra وحدة إلاّ عَشرَة
5 past 6	setteh w khamseh ستّة و خَمسة
5 to 6	setteh 'ella khamseh ستّة إلاّ خَمسة
11:45	tna3sh 'ella rebe3 تنعش و ربع
2:30	tnein(tentein) w noss تنين (تنتين) و نُصّ
3:25	tleiteh w noss 'ella khamseh تلاتي و نُصّ إلاّ خَمسة

3:35	tleiteh w noss w khamseh تلاتي و نُصّ و خَمسة
3:15	tleiteh w rebe3 تلاتي و ربع
3:20	tleiteh w telet تلاتي و تلت
3:40	arb3a ‘ella telet أربعَة إلاّ تلت
I'll be there in an hour or two	raH ousal ba3ed sei3a aw se3tein رَ أوصَل بَعد ساعَة أو ساعتَين
I waited for you for half an hour	natartak/ natartik noss sei3a نَطَرتَك/ نَطَرتِك نُصّ ساعَة
My sister arrives in 3 hours	ekhteh wasleh (raH tousal) ba3ed tleit se3at إختي واصلي (رَح توصَل) بَعد تلات ساعات
I will be with you in a minute	d'i'a w bkoun ma3ak/ ma3ik دقيقَة و بكون مَعَك

What time is it Canada time?	addeh el sei3a bi touw'eet canada?
	ادّي الساعَة بتوقيت كَنَدا؟
I have a meeting tomorrow at 5 pm	3andeh ejtimei3/ maw3ad boukra 3al sei3a khamseh ba3ed el doher
	عَندي إجتماع/ مَوعَد بُكرا على ساعَة خَمسة بَعد الضُّهر

INTERROGATIVE WORDS

Why?	leh/lesh?
	ليه/ ليش
When?	eimtan?
	أمتَن
Who?	meen?
	مين
Whose?	la meen?
	لَمين
How?	keef?
	كيف
What?	shou?
	شو
Where?	wein?
	وَين
What for?	la shou?
	لَشو
Since when?	min eimtan?
	مِن أمتَن
Why not?	lesh la'/ leh la'?
	ليش لاء

What else?	shou kamein?
	شو كَمان
How come?	keef ta?
	كيف تَ
How much?	addeh?
	أدّي
Why are you angry?	tm3assbeh/ m3asbeen?
	ليع معَّصَّب/ معَصبي/ معَصبين
When are you traveling?	eimtan mseifar/ mseifra/ mseifreen?
	أمتَن مسافَر/ مسافرَة/ مسافرين
Who is coming to the party?	meen jeyeh 3al sahra?
	مين جليي على سَهرَة
How are you today?	keefak/ keefik/ keefkoun el yom?
	كيفَك/ كيفِك/ كيفكُن
How is your father?	keefo bayyak/ bayyik/ baykoun?
	كيفو بيَّك/ بيِّك/ بيكُن
How is your mother?	keefa emmak/ emmik/ emkoun?
	كيفا إمَّك/ إمِّك/ إمكُن

How are your children?	keefoun wleidak/ wleidik/ wleidkoun? كيفُن ولادَك/ ولادِك/ ولادكُن
What is wrong with you ?	shou beik/ bekeh/ bekoun? شو باك/ بكي/ بكُن
Where are you going?	wein rayiH/ rayHa/ rayHeen? وَين رايح/ رايحا/ رايحين
What are these mugs for?	la shou hawdeh el kebbeiyeit? اَشو هَودي الكبايات
Since when do you wear black?	min emtan btelbous/ btelbseh/btelbso aswad? مِن أمتَن بتلبُس/ بتلبسي/ بتلبسوا أسوَد
What else do you suggest?	shou kamein btoktoriH/ btoktorHeh/ btoktorHo? شو كَمان بتُقطُرِح/ بتُقطُرحي/ بتُقطُرحوا

How come you are here?	keef ta enta/enteh/ento hon?
	كيف تَ إنتَ،/ إنتِ/ إنتو هون
How much does it cost?	addeh Ha'o/ Ha'a/ Ha'oun?
	أدّي حَقّو/ حَقّا/ حَقُّن

CHAPTER 2: CONJUGATION

I definitely hated conjugation at school. This is why I only chose to conjugate some pretty awesome verbs: to travel and to love. I believe that if we are constantly in love and visiting new places, then we are pretty close to finding happiness! In summer, Beirut international airport always witnesses high traffic of tourists and expatriates alike. If you haven't visited Lebanon yet, you really should plan a trip soon! Therefore I tell you

Tousal/ tousale bil salemeh (arrive safely!)

Hamdella 3al salemeh (Glad you arrived safely)

Songs: wein msafer, Julia Botros

TO LOVE

I love	ana bHebb
	أنا بحبّ

You love	enta betHebb/enteh betHebbeh إنتَ بتحبّ/ إنتِ بتحبّي
He loves	howeh biHebb هوّ بِحبّ
She loves	hiyyeh betHebb هِيّ بتحبّ
We love	neHna menHebb نِحنا منحبّ
You love	ento betHebbo إنتو بتحبّو
They love	henneh biHebbo هنّي بحبّو
I loved	ana Habbeit أنا حَبيت
You loved	enta Habbeit/enteh Habbayteh إنتَ حَبيت/ إنتِ حَبيتي
He loved	howeh Habb هوّ حَبّ
She loved	hiyeh Habbit هيّ حَبِّت

We loved	neHna Habbayna نحنا حَبينا
You loved	ento Habbayto إنتو حَبيتو
They loved	henneh Habbo هني حَبّو
I used to love	ana kenet Hebb أنا كنت حبّ
You used to love	enta kenet tHebb/enteh kenteh tHebbeh إنتَ كنت تحبّ/ إنتِ كنتي تحبّي
He used to love	howeh kein yHebb هوّ كان يحبّ
She used to love	hiyyeh keinit tHebb هيّ كانت تحبّ
We used to love	neHna kenna nHebb نحنا كنّا نحبّ
You used to love	ento kento tHebbo إنتو كنتو تحبّو
They used to love	henneh keino yHebbo هنّي كانو يحبّو

I will love	ana raH Hebb أنا رّح حبّ
You will love	enta raH tHebb/enteh raH tHebbeh إنتَ رَح تحبّ/ إنتي رَح تحبّي
He will love	howeh raH yHebb هوّ رَح يحبّ
She will love	hiyeh raH tHebb هيّ رَح تحبّ
We will love	neHna raH nHebb نحنا رَح نحب
You will love	ento raH tHebbo إنتو رَح تحبّو
They will love	henneh raH yHebbo هِنّي رَح يحبّوا
I used to love you when we were kids	ana kenet Hebbak lam-ma kenna wleid أنا كنت حبَّك/ حبِّك لَمّا كنا ولاد
He says he loves me like before	howeh bi'oul enno bi-Hebneh metel abel هوّ بِقول إنّو بِحبني متل قَبل

I'm sure you'll love Byblos when you go there	ana akeedeh raH tHebb Jbeil bas trouH/ trouHeh/trouHo أنا أكيد/ أكيدة رَح تحبّ جبيل بس تروح/ رح تحبّي جبيل بَس تروحي

TO TRAVEL

I travel	ana bseifir انا بسافِر
You travel	enta btseifir/ enteh btseifreh إنتَ بتسافِر/ إنتِ بتسافري
He travels	houwweh biseifir هُوّ بسافِر
She travels	hiyyeh btseifir هِيّ بتسافِر
We travel	neHna mnseifir نِحنا منسافِر
You travel	ento btseifro إنتو بتسافرو
They travel	henneh biseifro هِنّي بسافرو
I'm traveling	ana mseifar/ mseifra أنا مسافَر/ مسافرَة
You're traveling	enta mseifar/ enteh mseifra إنتَ مسافَر/ إنتِ مسافرَة

He's traveling	houwweh mseifar هُوّ مسافَر
She's traveling	hiyyeh mseifra هِيّ مسافرَة
We're traveling	neHna mseifreen نحنا مسافرين
You're traveling	ento mseifreen إنتو مسافرين
They're traveling	henneh mseifreen هِنّي مسافرين
I traveled	ana seifaret أنا سافَرت
You traveled	enta seifaret/ enteh sei-farteh إنتّ سافَرت/ إنتِ سافَرتي
He traveled	houwweh seifar هُوّ سافَر
She traveled	hiyyeh seifarit هِيّ سافَرِت
We traveled	neHna seifarna نِحنا سافَرنا

You traveled	ento seifarto إنتو سافَرتو
They traveled	henneh seifaro هِنّي سافَرو
I used to travel	ana kenet seifir أنا كنت سافِر
You used to travel	houwweh kein yseifir/ hiyyeh kenit tseifir إنتَ كنت تسافِر/ إنتِ كنتِ تسافري
He used to travel	houwweh kein yseifir هُوّ كان يسافِر
She used to travel	hiyyeh keinit tseifir هِيّ كانِت تسافِر
We used to travel	neHna kenna nseifir نِحنا كِنّا نسافِر
You used to travel	ento kento tseifro إنتو كنتو تسافرو
They used to travel	henneh keino yseifro هِنّي كانو يسافرو
I'll travel	ana raH seifir أنا رَح سافِر

You'll travel	enta raH tseifir/ enteh raH tseifreh
	إنتَ رَح تسافِر/ إنتِ رَح تسافري
He'll travel	houwweh raH yseifir
	هُوّ رَح يسافِر
She'll travel	hiyyeh raH tseifir
	هِيّ رَح تسافِر
We'll travel	neHna raH nseifir
	نِحنا رَح نسافِر
You'll travel	ento raH tseifro
	إنتو رَح تسافرو
They'll travel	henneh raH yseifro
	هِنّي رَح يسافرو
I'm traveling to paris today	ana mseifar/ mseifra 3ala beireez el yom
	أنا مسافَر/ مسافرَة عَلى باريز اليوم
I travel every summer	ana bseifir kel seif/ sayfiyyeh
	أنا بسافِر كِلّ صَيف/ صَيفيّة

Both my father and my brother , to brazil	khayyeh w bayyeh, seifaro el shaher el madeh 3ala el brazeel
	خَيِّ و بَيِّ، سافَروا الشَهر الماضي، عَلى البرازيل
We used to travel every year	neHna kenna nseifir kel seneh
	نِحنا كِنّا نسافِر كِلّ سنة
When will you travel?	eimtan raH tseifro?
	أمتَن رَح تسافرو؟

CHAPTER 3: AT HOME

Home! So what is it like living in a Lebanese home? No matter the class you come from, your weekly homemade menu would most certainly be made of Mjadra (lentils and cooked rice) and loubiyeh bi zeit (green beens in oil) on weekdays and Macheiweh (barbecue-meat, chicken and the like) on weekends. And yes family does come first. On Sundays, you are bound to invite your teta and jeddo, khalo and 3ammo (grand-parents and uncles) if they haven't sent you the invite first. I for one, usually fast on Saturday night so I can eat all the good stuff on Sunday!

Sahtein (Bon appétit)

Songs: beyti ana baytak, Feyrouz
beit sghir bi Canada, Feyrouz

INSIDE THE HOUSE

Home	beit
	بَيْت

Building	bineyeh بناية
Floor	tabe'/ tawabe' طابقِ/ طَوابِق
Bedroom	oudit el nom قوضِة النَوْم
Living room	oudit el a3deh قوضِة القَعْدِة
Kitchen	matbakh مَطبَخ
Bathroom	Hemmem حَمّام
Bed	takhet تَخْت
Closet	khzeineh خْزانة
Clothes	tyeib تياب
Towel	manshafeh مَنشَفة

Soap	saboun صابون
Oven/bakery	foren فُرن
Sink	majla مَجلَى
Dish	saHen صَحْن
Fork	shawkeh شَوْكِة
Knife	sekkeen سِكّين
Spoon	mal3a'a مَلْعقة
Cup	kebbeyeh كَبَاية
Couches	kanabeyeh كَنَبايِة
Table(s)	tawleh/ tawleit طَاوْلِة/ طاولات

Chair(s)	kerseh/ karaseh كِرسِي/ كَراسِي
On which floor is your apartment?	bi ayya tabe' enta 3ayesh/ enteh 3aysheh? بأيّ طابِق إنتَ عايش/ إنتِ عايشي؟
What are you cooking?	shou 3am totbokh/ totbkheh? شو عَم تُطبُخ/ تُطُبخي؟
I wash my face in the morning	el sobeH bghassil wejjeh الصُبُح بغَسِّل وِجِّي
How many times a day do you brush your teeth?	kam marra btfarsheh sneinak/ sneinik/ sneinkoun bil nhar? كَم مَرَّة بتفَرشي سنانَك/ سنانِك/ سنانكُن بالنهار؟
In the morning we go the bakery to buy manakeesh	el sobeH mnrouH 3al foren ta neshtreh mne'eesh الصُبُح مِنروح عَلى فُرن تَنِشتِري مْناقيش

I'm washing the dishes	ana 3am bejleh el sHoun
	أنا عَم بِجلي الصْحون

ORDERING FOOD

I would like to	badde بدّي
Street	sheri3 شارِع
Floor	tabi’ طابِق
Facing	bi wejj بِ وجّ
Near	Hadd حَدّ
Ask about	s’al 3ann سآل عنّ
Chicken	djeij دجاج
Garlic	toum توم
Pickles	kabees كَبيس
With	ma3 مَع

Without	bala بَلا
Extra	zyeideh زيادي
Cheese	jebneh جِبنة
Vegeterian	nabeiteh نَباتي
Ingredients	moukawwineit مُكونات
Mushrooms	foter فُطُر
To add	tzid تزيد
To remove	tshil تشيل
Mustard	khardal خَردَل
Dressing	salsa صَلصَة

Light	khafeef خَفيف
Cost/ Price	Ha'/ se3er حَقّ/ سِعر
I would like to order some food	baddeh otloub akel/tal-abiyyeh بَدّي أُطلُب أَكل/ طَلَبيّة
Where should it be delivered to?	la wein mnwassela? لَ وَين مِنوصّلا
St Lourdes street, on the fifth floor	ana 3aysheh bi sheri3 st lourde, bil tabi' el khamis أنا عايشي بشارِع سانت لورد، بالطابِق الخامِس
I want a chicken sand-wich without garlic, with pickles, extra hummus	baddeh 3arous djeij, bala toum, ma3 kabees, Hommous extra بَدّي عَروس دجاج، بَلا توم، مَع كبيس، أكسترا حُمّص
I want to order three pizza pepperoni, extra cheese	baddeh otloub tleiteh pizza pepperoni, zyedeh jebneh بَدّي أُطلُب تلاتي بيتزا ببروني زيادي جِبنة

Do you have vegetarian pizza	3andak/3andik/3andkoun pizza nabetiyeh
	عَندَك/عَندِك/ عَندكُن بيتزا نباتيّة
What are the toppings of the pizza?	shou btHot/ btHotteh/ btHotto fiya (or bi alba)
	شو بحُطّ/ بتحُطّي/ بتحُطّوا فيها (بِ قَلبا)
Can you remove the mushrooms	feek tshilleh/ feekeh tshileeleh/ feekoun tshilouleh el foter
	فيك تشلّي/ فيكي تشيليلي/ فيكُك تشيلولي الفُطُر
Can you add mustard	feek tzeed/ feekeh tzeedeh/ feekoun tzeedo khardal
	فيك تزيد/ فيكي تزيدي/ فيكُن تزيدو خَردَل
I want to change the dressing	baddeh ghayir el salsa
	بدّي غَيّر الصَلصَة
Do you have anything light to order?	shou 3andkoun shi khafeef (for a group of people)
	شو عَندكُن شي خَفيف

Today's special	taba' el yom
	طَبَق اليوم
What is today's special?	shou taba' el yom
	شو طَبَق اليوم
When will the food be ready?	ade bado wa'et el akel ta yousal
	أَدّي بَدّو وَقت الأكل تَ يوصَل
How much will the food cost	addeh byotla3 Ha' el akel?
	أدّي بِيطلَع حَقّ الأكل

WINTER

Winter	shiteh شِتي
Cold	sa'3a سَقعَة
Storm	3asfeh عَاصِفِة
Snow	talej تَلج
Road	taree' طَريق
Electrical heater	deffeiyeh دِفّاية
Chimney	maw'adeh/ shemineh شوميني
Coal	Hatab حَطَب
Winter food	akel el shiteh أكل الشِتي
Chestnut	kastana كَستنا

Grilled potatoes	batata meshwiyeh بطاطا مِشويّة
Soup	shawraba شَوَبَة
Scarf	sheil شال
Gloves	kfouf كفوف
Hat	bornayta بُرنَيطَة
Coat	kabbout كَبّوت
It's really cold today	el yom, kteer sa'3a اليوم، كنير سَقعَة
There is a storm coming soon	fi 3asfeh jeiyeh areeban "في عاصفِة جايي قَريبا
It snowed yesterday	talajit mbeiriH تَلَجِت مبارِح
The road was blocked	el taree' kein ma'tou3/ msakkar الطَريق كان مَقطوع/ مسَكّر

It's too cold, i can't go out, so not to catch a cold	kteer sa'3a, ma feeneh odhar, ta ma omrad
	كتير سَقعَة، ما فيني أُضهّر، تَ ما أُمرَض
Heaters	wasei'il tadfi'a
	وَسائل تَدفِءة
I am going to the snow	ana rayHa/ rayiH 3al talej
	انا رايحل على تَلج
I am going skiing	ana rayHa/ rayiH a3moul ski
	أنا رايحا أعمُل سكي
Keep warm	tddaffeh/ tdaffa/ tdaffo mniH
	تدَفّى/ تدفّي/ تدفّوا منيح

CHAPTER 4: WORK AND STUDYING

For me, unlike school, university has been a really fun time. After all, I studied drama! In Lebanon, children go to school for 15 years starting at age 3. Lebanon once again offers various top-notch schools and universities that provide high quality education.

As for work, it is certainly not very easy to find a job here! Demands obviously exceed offers leading thus to increasing immigration.

Ya3tik/ ya3tikeh el 3afyeh (after someone finishes any kind of physical or intellectual task).

Songs: chtegil w ma to'bad ya Habboub, ghassan el raHbani

STUDYING

Pencil	alam rsas قَلَم رصاص
Pen	alam قَلَم

Paper	war'a وَرقة
I write	bektoub بِكتُب
Book	kteib كتاب
Notebook	daftar دَفتَر
Ruler	mastara مَسطَرَة
Board	lawH لّوح
Teacher (man)	esteiz إستاذ
Teacher (woman)	m3almeh معَلمة
I am a student	ana tilmeez/ tilmeezeh أنا تلميذ/ تلميذة
I study Arabic	ana bedrous 3arabeh أنا بدرُس عَرَبي
I study at the Lebanese university	ana bedrous bil jeim3a el lebneiniyeh أنا بدرُس بالجامعة اللّبنانيّة

I am a student of Arabic at the Lebanese university	ana telmeez/telmeezeh, w bedrous 3arabeh bil jeim3a el lebneiniyeh أنا تلمبذ/تِلميذة، وبدرُس عَرَبي بالجامعَة اللّبنانيّة
I write with the pen on the paper	ana bektoub bil alam 3ala el war'a أنا بِكتُب بالقَلَم عَلى الوَرقَة
May i go to the bathroom	fineh rouH 3al Hemmeim فيني روح عَلى حَمّام
Can you lend me your pen?	feek t3eerneh/ feekeh t3ireeneh/ feekoun t3irouneh alam? فيك تعيرني قَلَم/ فيكي تعيريني قَلَم/ فيكُن تعيروني قلَم

JOBS

Job	sheghel شغل
Jobs	ashghal اشغال
Cobbler	kindarjeh كِندَرجي
Blacksmith	Heddeid حِدّاد
Carpenter	najjar نَجّار
Mechanic	mecanisiein ميكانيسيان
Grocery store	dikkein دِكّان
Grocery-man	dikkanjeh دِكَّنجي
Vegetables	khodra خُضرَة
Greengrocer	khadarjeh خَضَرجي

Garden	jnayneh جنَينِة
Gardener	jnayneiteh جنيناتي
Bread	khebez خِبز
Bread maker/ baker	khebbeiz / forran خِبّاز/ فُرّان
Hairdresser	Hellei'/ coiffeur حِلاّق/ حِلاقَة
Fortune teller	bossar/ bossara بَّصّار/ بَصّارَة
House painter	torrash طُرّاش
Tiles	blat بلاط
Tiler	bollat بُلاّط
Electrician	kahrabjeh كَهرَبجي

Doorman	natour
	ناطور
Tailor	khiyyat/ khiyyata
	خِيّاط/ خِيّاطَة

CHAPTER 5: BODY AND DOCTORS

Not a happy chapter hein? But hey, think about the cure not the illness. There is at least one doctor in every family. Not only is it a source of pride for every extended family member, but also a national glorification. Lebanese doctors have indeed excelled in various domains. Plastic surgery makes no exception, it actually gave birth to medical tourism whereas many arrive to our capital in the hope of leaving it looking even prettier!

3a salemeh then (may you have a fast and easy recovery)

Songs:

Saydali ya saydali , azar Habib (saydali means pharmacist)

Tabib garraH, georges wassouf (tabib is another word for doctor)

BODY

Body	jesem
	جِسم

Face	wejj وِجّ
Eyebrows	Hweijjib حواجِب
Nose	menkhar/mankhour مِنخار/مَنخور
Eye	3ayn عَين
Eyes	3youn عيون
Eyelashes	rmoush رموش
Mouth	temm تِمّ
Cheek	khadd خدّ
Cheeks	khdoud خدود
Hair	sha3er شَعر

Neck	ra'beh
	رَقبة
Chest/breast	soder
	صُدر
Shoulders	kteif
	كتاف
Arm	eed
	إيد
Stomach	me3deh
	مِعدة
Belly	baten
	بَطن
Hips	wrak
	وراك
Waist	khaser
	خَصر
Leg	ejer
	إجر
Legs	ejrein
	إجرين

Knee	rekbeh
	رِكبة
Fingers	asabe3
	أصابع
Toes	asabe3 el ejrein
	أصابع الإجرين
Head	ras
	راس
Ear	dayneh
	دَينه
Ears	dinein
	دينَين
Mole	shemiyeh
	شاميّة
Tooth	sinn
	سِنّ
Teeth	snein
	سنان
Tongue	lsein
	لسان

Lip	shiffeh شِفّه
Lips	shfeif شفاف
My body hurts	jesmeh 3am youja3neh جِسمي عَم يوجَعني
This girl has long hair	heydeh el benet sha3ra taweel هيدي البنت شعرا طويل
This boy has long hair	heyda el sabeh sha3ro aseer هيدا الصبي شعرو طويل
I have a headache	raseh 3am youja3neh راسي عم يوجعني
This girl is so skinny	heydeh el benet kteer d3ifeh هيدي البنت كتير ضعيفه
This boy is overweight	heyda el sabeh naseH هيدا الصَبي ناصِح

DOCTOR

Advice	nasiHa نَصيحَة
Cause	sabab? سَبَب
Hereditary	wirateh وِراتي
Medicine	dawa دَوا
Medicines	edewyeh إدوية
I'm sick	ana mareed/ mareeda sakhin/ sakhneh أنا مَريض/ مَريضَة صاخِن/ صاخنة
I'm feeling tired	ana te3bein/ te3beineh أنا تعبان/ تعبانة
I want to see a doctor	baddeh shouf Hakeem/ Hakeemeh بَدّي شوف حَكيم/ حَكيمة

Can you recommend a good doctor	feek tonsaHneh/ feekeh tonsaHeeneh bi Hakeem/ Hakeemeh shatir/ shatra
	فيك تُنصَحني بحكيم شاطِر/ فيكي تُنصَحيني بحَكيمي شاطرَة
I feel pain in my stomach	Hasis/ Hasseh bi waja3 bi me3dteh
	حاسِس/ حاسّي بِوَجَع بمعدتي
I have a headache	raseh 3am youja3neh
	راسي عَ يوجَعني
My arm hurts	eedeh 3am touja3neh
	إدي عَم توجَعني
Doctor, is it something serious (dangerous)?	Hakeem, fi shi khotir?
	حَكيم، في شي خُطِر؟
What's causing me this pain?	shou yalleh 3am bisabbebleh hal waja3?
	شو يَلّي عَم بِسبّبلي هَل وَجَع
Is there a solution/ treatment?	fi Hall/ 3ileij?
	في حَلّ/ عِلاج
Are there more tests to be done?	leizim a3moul ba3ed fHousat?
	لازِم أعمُل بَعد فحوصات؟

Is surgery necessary?	bte3te'id/ bte3te'deh lezim a3moul 3amaliyeh?
	بتعتقد/ بتعتقدي لازم أعمُل عمَليّة؟
What you are feeling	khabberneh shou Hassis/ khabreeneh shou Hasseh
	خَبّرني شو حاسِس/ خَبريني شو حاسّي
Where does it hurt?	wein 3am youja3ak/ youja3ik?
	وَين عَم يوجَعَك/ يوجَعِك؟
Have long have you been feeling this pain?	addeh sarlo el waja3 (addeh sarlak mawjou3/ mawjou3a)?
	أدّي صَرلو الوَجَع (أدّي صَرلَك موجوع/ موجوعَة)
Is it something common in your family	hal hayda shi wirateh bi 3ayltak/ 3ayltik?
	هَل هَيدا شي وِراتي بعَيلتَك/ عيلتِك؟
Do you have any chronic disease?	3andak/ 3andik amrad mouzmineh?
	عَندَك/ عندِك أمراض مُزمِنة؟

Do you have any kind of allergies?	3andak/ 3andik Haseisiyeh 3a shi?
	عَندَك/ عَندِك حَساسِيّة عَشي؟
Take this medicine three times per day	khod/ khedeh el dawa tleit marrat bil nhar
	خود/ خِدي الدَوا تلات مَرّات بالنهار

CHAPTER 6: POLITICS

I definitely dislike this chapter. Nowadays Politics mean war, agonizing kids, terrorism, world hunger and every other atrocity one can think of…It goes without saying that Lebanese politics leave much to envy as means of conducting a country!

Wishing for peace and peace only.

PART 1

Politics	siyeiseh
	سياسِة
Country	balad
	بَلَد
Capital	3aasmeh
	عاصمة

State	dawleh/wileiyeh
	دَولة/ وِلاية
President	ra'ees/ra'eeseh
	رَئيس/ة
King	malik
	مَلِك
Queen	malikeh
	مَلِكة
Republic	joumhouriyeh
	جُمهورِيّة
Kingdom	mamlakeh
	مَملَكِة
Parliament	barlamein
	بَرلَمان
Ministry	wizara
	وِزارَة
Minister	wazeer
	وَزير
Ministers	wouzara
	وُزَرا

Representative	neiyib نايب
Representatives	nouwweib نُوّاب
Nation	oummeh أُمّة
Party	Hezeb حِزب
Parties	aHzeib أحزاب
Elections	intikhabeit إنتِخابات
Revolution	sawra ثَورَة
The capital of Lebanon is Beirut	3aasmit lebnein, beirut عاصمِة لبنان, بَيروت
Republic of Lebanon	joumhouriyet lebnein/ el joumhouriyeh el lebneiniyeh جُمهوريّة لبنان/ الجُمهوريّة اللّبنانيّة

United nations	el oumam el meteHdeh
	الأُمَم المِتِّحْدة
Today, the representatives met at the parliament to elect a president	el yom, el nouwweib jtama3o bil barlamein ta yentekhbo ra'ees
	اليوم, النوّاب جتمعوا تينتخبوا رئيس
There are two main political parties in the United States	fi Hezbein aseisiyyeh bil wileiyeit el metteHdeh
	في حِزبين أساسيّة بالولايات المتِّحْدة

PART 2

Municipality/ies	baladiyyeh/ baladiyyeit بَلَدِيّة/ بَلَدِيّات
Peace	saleim سَلام
Peaceful	selmiyyeh سِلميّة
Protest	mouzahara مُظاهَرَة
Protests	mouzaharat مُظاهَرات
Martyr	shaheed شهيد
There is a garbage crisis in Lebanon, and the government did not find a solution yet.	fi azmit nifeiyeit bi lebnen, wl Hkoumeh ba3ed ma le'yit Hall في أزمِة نفِايات بِلبنان، والحكومِة بَعد ما لقيت حَلّ
Every municipality is responsible for sorting and recycling waste	kel baladiyyeh, mas'ouleh 3an farez el nifeiyeit كِلّ بَلَدِيّة، مَسؤولِة عَن فَرز النِفايات

There are ongoing peaceful protests in the Lebanese capital demanding the resignation of the minister of the environment	fi mouzaharat selmiyyeh moustamerra bil 3asmeh el lebneniyeh, 3am bettalib bi esti'alit wazeer el bee'a
	في مُظاهرات سِلميّة مُستمرّة بالعاصمة اللبنانية، عَم بطالِب بإستقالة وَزير البيئة
Today, fifty people were killed after an explosion	el yom, khamseen shakhes meito nateejit enfijar
	اليَوم، خَمسين شَخص ماتوا نَتيجِة إنفجار
In 2013, the parliament amended the constitution extending thus their term	bil alfein w tleta3sh, majlis el nouwweib 3addalo el doustour, ta ye'daro ymaddido la nafsoun
	بل ألفين وتلاتعش مَجلِس النّواب عَدَّلوا الدُستور، تَ يقدَروا يمَدّدوا لَ نَفسُن

CHAPTER 7: FORMALITIES

Ah formalities… This is definitely a chapter that all Lebanese are very familiar with. We've been raised hearing a lot of "3ayb" (fault/ disgrace), of kellak zo2 (you're full of good manners), of iza ma fi te2leh (if it's not too much to ask)…

Lebanese are attached to traditions. Some are still very pleasant to see: standing up when someone walks in or out of a room, visiting your grandparents every week, walking with your guest to the door and staying a few or long moments saying goodbye and 're'-catching up… I still remember as a kid, searching for my mother only to find her 30 minutes later at the door still conversing with her favorite neighbor Tante Rita!

Nowadays, a lot of this happens through social media, including a visit to your grandparents…

AT THE DOOR

Good luck	mwaffa'/ mwaffa'a/ mwaffa'een
	موَفَق/ موَفَقَة/ موَفَقين

Godspeed	ma3 el saleimeh مَع السَلامة
Why don't you stay?	khalleek/ khalleekeh/ khalleekoun خَلّيك/ خَلّيكي/ خَلّيكُن
Stay a little longer	khalleek (b'a) ba3d shwey خَلّيك (بقا) بَعد شوي
God be with you	allah ma3ak/ ma3ik/ ma3koun الله مَعَك/ مَعِك/ مَعكُن
Pass by soon	teb'a toll/ teb'eh tolleh/ teb'o tollo تبقَ طُلّ/ تبقي طُلّي/ تبقو طُلّو
Why don't you pass by?	mayyil/ mayleh/ maylo مَيّل/ مَيلي/ مَيلو
Come back again	3eeda/ 3idiya/ 3idouwa عيدا/ عيديا/ عيدووا
Where are you going?	la wein? لَوين?
Come again: (for individuals and groups alike)	min3adeh مِنعادة

Goodnight	sa3eedeh/ tosbaH 3a kheir سَعيدة/ تُصبَح ع خَير
Goodnight (as a reply to the above)	w enta/enteh/ ento min ahlo و إنتَ/ إنتِ/ إنتو من أهلو
Say hi to...	sallim/ salmeh/ salmo سَلِّم/ سَلمي/ سَلمو
Will do	wosil وُصِل
OK, i have to go	yalla, sar lezim emsheh يَلاّ صار لازِم إمشي
We have to leave (Literal Translation: "OK, we saw you")	yalla shefneikoun يلاّ شفناكُن
Is there anything i can do before i leave?	baddak, baddik, badkoun shi? بَدَّك/ بَدِّك/ بَدكُن شي؟
We're happy to have seen you	mbasatna shefneikoun مبسَطنا شفناكُن
We will come again	min3eeda gheir marra منعيدا غَير مَرّا

MANNERS

Please	3mol/3meleh ma3rouf
	عمول/ عميلي مَعروف
	min fadlak/ min fadlik
	مِن فَضلَك/ فَضلِك
	Bi sharafak/bi sharafik
	بِشَرَفَك/ بِشَرَفِك
	ma tosghar
	ما تُصغَر
	iza btreed/ btreedeh
	إذا بتريد/ بتريدي
Excuse me	3afwan
	عَفوا”
	b3azbak/b3azbik
	بعَزبَك/ بعَزبِك
	law samaHet/ law samaHteh
	لَو سَمَحت/ لَو سَمَحتي
	ma twekhezneh/ ma twekhzeeneh
	ما تواخزني/ تواخزيني
	min ba3ed eznak/ eznik
	مِن بَعد إذنَك/ إذنِك

You're welcome	tekram 3aynak/3aynik
	تكرَم عَينَك/ عَينِك
	tekram/ tekrameh
	تِكرَم/ تِكرَمي
	ahla
	أهلا
	ya 3eib el shoum
	يا عَيب الشوم
	la 3younak/ 3younik
	لَعيونَك/ لَعيونِك
Don't mention it	mish bayneitna
	مِش بيناتنا
	walaw
	وَلَو

Thank you	yeslamo
	يِسلَمو
	ysallemoun
	يسلّمُن
	teslam
	تسلَم
	yeslamo hal idein
	يسلَمو هَل إدين
	shoukran
	"شُكرا
	mashkour / mashkoura
	مَشكور/ مَشكورَة
	kellak/ kellik zo'
	كِلَّك/ كِلِّك زوق
	khajjaltna/ khajjalteena
	خَجَلتنا/ خَجَلتينا

Salutation/ hope to find you well	ykhaleelna yeik/ yeikeh
	يخَليلنا ياك
	ykhaleek/ ykhaleekeh fo' rasna
	يخلّيك/ يخَلّيكي فوق راسنا
	allah yoHfazak
	الله يُحفَظَك/ يُحفَظِك
	allah ykhalleek
	الله يخَلّيك/ يخَلّيكي
	ya3teek/ ya3teekeh el 3afyeh
	يَعطيك/ يَعطيكي العافية
	allah y3afeek/ y3afeekeh
	الله يعافيك: يعافيكي
Your wish is my command	b amrak/ b amrik
	بِأمرَك
Is it ok?	ma3leh iza?
	مَعلي إذا؟
Do you have any problem with that?	3andak/3andik meshkleh?
	عَندَك/ عَندِك مشكلة؟

No problem	mish meshkleh
	مِش مشكلة
It doesn't matter	ma bi'assir
	ما بِأسّر

CHAPTER 8: MISCELLANEOUS

The word extra is used a lot in daily situations. Especially when ordering street food you would say: I want one faleifil, with extra tarator (taHini dressing)

Baddeh waHad faleifil, tarator extra.

Now this chapter sheds light on "soccer". And when it comes to soccer, Lebanese take it pretty seriously. Our two most popular football teams are el nejmeh (the star) and el ansar (the fans) both based in Beirut. International championships barely leave any Lebanese neutral. Fans are highly supportive of either the Brazilian or the German team… Restaurants, Cafés and every single balcony would be stacked with people watching the game and cheering their favorite players while wearing the full (authentic or not) team's uniform of course. Celebrations will then follow throughout the night with fans honking cars making as much noise as possible so that no adversary shall ever find sleep again!

Wazzeklo (when you make fun of the other team's fans because they lost)

Mabrouk: to congratulate the fans of the team that won.

Songs: mabrouk mabrouk, rami ayyach

WORLD CUP

Team	faree’
	فَريق
Player/s	lei3ib/lei3beh/la3eebeh
	لاعِب/لاعبي/ لَعّيبي
I’m with	ana ma3
	أنا مَع
I’m against	ana dodd
	أنا ضُد
Gain	rebeH
	ربح
Loss	khsara
	خسارَة
Spanish team	faree’ espaneh
	فَريق إسباني
Brazilian team	faree’ brazeeleh
	فَريق برازيلي
Italian team	faree’ telyeineh (or italeh)
	فَريق طلياني/ إطالي

German team	faree' almaneh
	فَريق ألماني
French team	faree' faranseh (or frenseiweh)
	فَريق فَرَنسي/ فرنساوي
World cup	ka'es el 3alam/ mondial
	كأس العالَم
What's your favorite team?	enta/enteh ma3 ayya faree'/ aya faree' btshaji3/btshaj3eh
	إنتَ/إنتِ أيّا فريق بتشَجّع/ بتشَجعي
This year, the world cup is in Brazil	heydeh el seneh, ka'es el 3alam bil brazeel
	هَيدي السنة، كأس العالم بالبرازيل
Four years ago, it was in South Africa	min arba3 sneen, kein bi afree'ya el jnoubiyeh
	مِن أربَع سنين، كان بأفريقيا الجنوبيّة
She supports the Spanish team	hiyeh ma3 el faree' el espaneh
	هيّ مَع الفَريق الأسباني

This year I won't cheer for any team	heydeh el seneh, ana manneh ma3 wala faree'
	هَيدي السنة، أنا مَنّي مَع ولا فَريق
My team will win	faree'eh raH yerbaH
	فَريقي رَح يربَح
I hope your team loses	betmanna faree'ak/ faree'ik yekhsar
	بتمنّى فريقَك/ فَريقِك يخسَر

CHAPTER 9: TEXTS

PRESENT TENSE

First visit to Lebanon

I now arrive to Rafi' el Hariri Airport in Beirut. It's the first time I visit Lebanon. My name is Nora and my father is Lebanese, my mother is English.

My father each day tells me about Lebanon and about Khyeim, his village in southern Lebanon. I'm so excited to go to the south, but before I want to explore Beirut.

My friend Maher, is waiting for me outside the airport, he wants to invite me to lunch at a restaurant in Hamra.

(Nora and Maher in front of the airport)

Nora: Maher! I'm here, I miss you a lot!

Maher: Nora ya Nora, missing you a lot, finally you came to Lebanon! I hope you are hungry because I'm inviting you to the best restaurant in the town.

Nora: I'm starving, looking forward!

(In the car)

Nora: Ohhhh, too much traffic! It's been 1 hour on the

road!

Maher: yeah it's normal, this is Beirut! From the airport to Hamra you need ten minutes in the night, but one hour in the day!

Nora: and ohhh it's so hot, I'm suffocating!

Maher: if you keep on nagging, I'll throw you outside the car hahaha

(At the restaurant)

Nora: finally we arrive to the restaurant, my mood changed! After the hot weather and the traffic I'm going to order Tabbouleh.

Maher: heh, are we just going to eat Tabbouleh? You will see, I'm going to ask for a special meza. Excuse me, we want to order.

Waiter: Go ahead.

Maher: Ok so, we want 1 dish of tabbouleh, 1 dish of spiced potatoes, 1 Hummus, 1 plate of raw sheep's liver, 1 plate of fried kebbeh and of course 2 glasses of 3ara'.

(Nora on the phone)

Hello, good evening dad. I can't tell you how happy I am! I wish you are with me. I'm now in Rawche doing sports and after going to party in Mar Mkhayel. How is the weather? It's too hot but more chilling in the evening than in the day.

I'm going to Khyeim on Sunday, ok I kiss you and big hello to mom. Love you!

---

awwal zyara 3ala lebnein

ana halla' wsolet 3a matar rafee' el Hariri Beirut. heydeh awwal marra bzour lebnein. esmeh nora w bayyeh lebneineh, emmeh engliziyeh.

bayyeh kel yom bikhaberneh 3an lebnein w 3an day3to bil khyeim bi jnoub lebnein. ana kteer mHammasseh rouH 3al jnoub, bas abel baddeh ekteshif beirut.

rfee'eh maher naterneh barrat el matar, baddo ye3zemneh

3al ghada bi mat3am bil Hamra.

(nora w maher eddeim el matar)

nora: maher! ana hon, shta'tellak kteer!

maher: nora ya nora! meshta'lik kteer, akheeran jeeteh 3ala lebnein! yalla nshala tkouneh je3aneh l'en 3eizmik 3a atyab mat3am bil balad

nora: mkhawra! badeh el sarfeh ousal!

(bil siyara)

nora: ufffff, shou fi 3aj'a! sarlna sei3a 3al taree' !

maher : eh shi tabee3eh, heydeh beirut ! min el matar lal Hamra baddik 3asher d'ayi' bil leil, bas bil nhar sei3a !

nora : w ufff shou fi shob, ftoset !

maher : iza raH tdalleh tne'eh, bkebbik min el siyara hahaha-ha

(bil mat3am)

nora: akheeran wsolna 3al mat3am, tghayarit nafseeteh. min ba3ed el shob wl 3aj'a, raH otloub tabbouleh.

maher: heh, bas raH neikoul tabbouleh? halla' btshoufeh, raH otloub mezza gheir shikel. 3afwan, badna notloub.

waiter: yalla tfaddal

maher: tayyib, badna saHen tabbouleh, saHen batata Harra, waHad Hommous, saHen asbeh nayyeh, w sahen kebbeh me'liyeh w akeed keisein 3ara' 3ala zaw'ak

(nora 3al telephone)

- allo masa el kheir baba. ma bkhabrak addeh mabsouta ana! ya reit enta ma3eh! ana hala' 3al rawsheh 3am ba3moul riyada w ba3dein rayHa osshar bi mar mkhayel. keef el ta'es? shob kteer kteer bas bil leil fi shwey broud aHsan min el nhar.

ana el aHad rayHa 3al khyeim, yalla bbousak w sallim 3ala mama kteer. bHebbak.

PAST TENSE

Today I woke up at 6.30 in the morning, I drank my coffee, took a shower, got dressed and left home. Since I was going to Achrafieh, I waited for a taxi on the street. When the first one arrived, I told the driver: to Achrafieh, but he answered that he was not going there. I kept waiting till another one came by and I said again: Achrafieh? He replied: servicein (double the charge) Achrafieh is far. I agreed. As I sat down, I paid 4000ll and finally reached my destination. There, I sat at a café that served delicious coffee. I ordered a latte with no sugar and waited for the meeting I had. When the guy arrived, I said: Hello, I am Hiba and he replied: I'm Mohammad. Mohammad and I talked, discussed some issues and agreed to start up our charity organization as of next week. I'll tell you all the details in an up-coming video. We finished the meeting and I felt very hungry. I called my friend and said: Allo, hi Christelle, do you have time for lunch? She said yes, and so we met at an Italian restaurant that serves excellent pizza. I ordered a Margherita and Christelle had a vegetarian. We ate, had a glass of wine, paid the bill then I went home by service while she headed back to work. I reached home, made coffee and sat on the balcony, then felt that the weather is really nice and that spring has started. I drank my coffee and that's how I spent my day. See you soon.

---

el yom w3eet 3al sei3a setteh w noss el sobeH, shrebet ahweh, tHammamet, akalet, lbeset tyeibeh w daharet min el beit.

kenet rayHa 3al Ashrafiyeh. w'efet 3al taree' nataret "service". Wosil awwal waHad, eltello: "3al Ashrafiyeh?", alleh: "mish wasil". nataret siyyara teinyeh, eltello: "marHaba, 3al Ashrafiyeh?", alleh: "servicein (2 services), el Ashrafiyeh b3eedeh". eltello ok!

tlo3et bil siyyara, dafa3tello arba3-t-aleif, w wsolet 3al Ashrafiyeh. honik a3adet bi ahweh, 3anda ahweh taybeh kteer.

talabet ahweh bi Haleeb bala sekkar, w nataret el ejtimei3 yalleh kein 3andeh yeh.

nataret el zalameh w wosil eltello: "marHaba ana hiba", alleh: " ahla, ana mHammad". Hkeena ana w mHammad w ttafa'na nballich sheghel jdeed el osbou3 li jeiyeh.

ana w mHammad raH neftaH jam3iyyeh khayriyeh, bkhaberkoun 3an el tafaseel bi video teineh. khalasna el ejtimei3 w Hasseit enneh je3aneh kteer. Da'eit la rfee'teh eltella: " allo hi christelle, ma3keh wa'et netghadda ? » aletleh eh !

lta'ayna ana w christelle, bi mat3am telyeineh 3ando pizza taybeh kteer. ana talabet pizza Margherita, w christelle talabit pizza nabeitiyeh. akalna w shrebna keis nbeed abyad. dafa3na el Hseib, w ana rje3et 3ala beyteh service, w hiyyeh rej3it 3ala sheghla.

wsolet 3al beit, 3melet ahweh, a3adet 3al balcon, w Hasseit eno el ta'es Helo kteer w ballash el rabee3. shrebet ahweh w heik bikoun kholis el nhar lal yom. bshoufkoun areeban!

FUTURE TENSE

Beach tomorrow?
(a dialogue between Yasmine and Salwa)

-Yasmine: How do you think the weather will be tomorrow?

- Salwa: Tomorrow, it may rain. But the day after tomorrow the weather will surely be beautiful and sunny.

- Yasmine: So we'll go to the beach after tomorrow.

- Salwa: Rabih and I can't, we have work. But tomorrow we're taking the day off.

- Yasmine: OK, so we'll go to the beach tomorrow for sure. Do not forget to call Yasmine and ask her if she feels like coming with us.

- Salwa: I will call her later. Who else do you want to invite? Maybe Talal and his family?

- Yasmine: Yes his wife is nice, and that way, his children will play with ours. We will have fun. Who will take us?

- Salwa: We'll take two cars. One group will go with me and one group with Talal, if he comes.
- Yasmine: If we tell him that lunch will be fish and Arak, he will come for sure.
- Salwa: So the plan is fixed. It's like we're traveling! We've been talking about it for one week!
- Yasmine: True! OK so I will get moving. What will you do?
- Salwa: I will finish some work before the kids arrive. I want to send an email to a client to show him how work is progressing. Then I will shower and wear my clothes so I go bring the kids from school. And you, what are you up to?
- Yasmine: Me too I have work. And in the afternoon we're going to the mountain, the weather is wonderful now. We will run and maybe we sleep there.
- Salwa: The important thing is that you don't get late for the beach tomorrow.
- Yasmine: Don't worry! Do you need anything?
- Salwa: Thanks you!

---

baHer boukra?
(Hiwar bein Yasmine w Salwa)

Yasmine: kif awlik raH ykoun el taeis boukra?
Salwa: boukra ma32oul tchatteh. Bas ba3ed boukra akid el taeis Helo w saHo
Yasmine: laken mnrouH ba3ed boukra 3al baHer
Salwa : Ana w rabi3 ma fina, 3anna chegeil. Bas boukra ekh-din (3anna) forsa
Yasmine : Tayyib kalas, 3al akid boukra mnrouH 3al baHer. Ma tense tde22e la Yasmine tes2aliya iza 3abela teje ma3na.
Salwa : hala2 ba3ed chway btalfenla (bottosil fiya/ behkiya/ bde22ela) ok. Min baddik ne3zoum kamen? barke Talal w 3aylto?
Yasmine: Eh marto lazizeh ktir w heik wledo byel3abo ma3

wledna (el wleid byel3abo ma3 ba3ed). raH netsalla. Ma3 min mnrouH (raH nrouH)

Salwa : MnrouH siyartein. 2osem ma3e w 2osem ma3 Talal iza eja.

Yasmine: Iza mn2ello el ghada samak w 3ara2 3al akid byeje

Salwa: Laken tamem rekib el machrou3. Uf kaenno msefrin. sarlna jem3a bi hal sireh (mne7ke 3an el mawdou3)

Yasmine: 3angad! Tayyib (tab) ana raH emche. Chou 3amleh?

Salwa: RaH khalis kam chagleh abeil ma yousalo el wled. bade eb3at emails lal zboun farji wein wsoleit bil chegeil. Ba3dein raH etHammam w elbous ta rouH jiboun (jib el wled) mn el madrase. Ente chou 3amleh?

Yasmine: Ana kamen 3ande chegeil. w ba3ed el doher tal3in 3al jabal, bi3a2id el taeis hala2. RaH nrouH nerkoud w barke mnnem fo2.

Salwa: Mouhem ma tet2akharo 3al baHer boukra. Yalla bchoufik!

Yasmine : Ma te3tale hamm. Baddik chi?

Salwa: Salemtik, bchoufik boukra!

بَحر بُكرا؟
(حِوار بَين يَسمين و سَلوَة)

يَسمين: كيف قَولِك رَح يكون الطَقس بُكرا؟
سَلوَة: بُكرا مَعقول تشَتّي، بَس بَعد بُكرا أكيد الطَقس حِلو و صَحو
يَسمين: لَكان مِنروح بَعد بُكرا على بَحر
سلوة: أنا و رَبيع ما فينا، عَنّا شِغل، بَس بُكرا آخدين فُرصَة
يسمين: طَيِّب خَلَص، على أكيد بُكرا مِنروح على بَحر. ما تِنسي تدقّي لَيَسمين، تِسأليا إذا عَبالا تجي مَعنا
سلوة: هَلَّء بَعد شوَيّ بتَلفِنلا أوكي. مين بَدِّك نعزم كَمان؟ بَركي طَلال و عَيلتو؟
يسمين: إي مَرتو لَذيذِة كتير، و هيك ولادو بيلعَبوا مَع ولادنا . رَح نِتسَلاّ. مَع مين منروح؟

سلوة: منروح سِيّارتين. قُسم مَعي و قُسم مَع طلال إذا إجا
يسمين: إذا منقلّو الغَدا سَمَك و عَرَق، على أكيد بيجي
سلوة: لَكان تَمام، رِكِب المَشروع! أوف كَإنّو مسافرين. صَرلنا جِمعَة بِهَل سيرِة
يسمين: عَنجَدّ! طَيّب أنا رَح إمشي، شو عامِلِة؟
سلوة: رَح خَلِّص كَم شَغلِة قَبل ما يوصَلو الولاد. بَدّي إبعَت "إميلز" للزبون، فَرجي وين وصُلت بالشِغل. بَعدين رَح إتحَمَّم و إلبُس تَروح جيبُن من المَدرَسِة. إنتِ شو عامِلِة؟
يسمين: أنا كَمان عَندي شِغل، و بَعد الضُهر طالعين على جَبَل. بِعَقِّد الطَقس هَلَّء. رَح نروح نِركُض و بَركي مِنّام فوق
سلوة: مُهِمّ ما تِتأخَّروا على بَحر بُكرا
يسمين: ما تِعتَلي هَمّ. بَدِّك شي؟
سلوة: سلامتِك، بشوفِك بُكرا

CHAPTER 10: EXERCISES

EXERCISE NUMBER 1

Fill in the blanks:

1. Where do you live?
   Weyn _____?
2. When do you want to eat?
   _____ badak _____?
3. Who are you?
   _____ inta?
4. Why are you sad?
   _____?
5. What do you think about these curtains?
   _____ ra'yak bi hal _____?

Answers:

1)	Sekin/ 3ayich	ساكِن/ عايِش
2)	Emtan badkoun teklo	أمتَن بَدكُن تاكلوا؟
3)	Min	مين
4)	Leh ze3len/ ze3leneh	ليه زعلان/ زعلانِة
5)	Chou ra'yak bi hal baradeh	شو رَأيَك بهَل بَرادي ؟

EXERCISE NUMBER 2
Find the questions to these answers:

1) Ana men lebnen. أنا مِن لِبنان

_____

2) Ana asleh frenseweh /faranseh أنا أصلي فرنساوي /فرنسي

_____

3) Ana nejjar. أنا نِجّار

_____

4) Ana marid. أنا مَريض

_____

5) La2 yeslamo bekhod taxi. لاء يِسلَمو باخُد تاكسي

_____

6) Sekin bi Jbeil. ساكِن بِجبَيل

_____

Answers:

1)	Men weyn inte?	شو جِنسيتك/ مِن وَين إنت؟
2)	Men weyn inte?	مِن وَين الأصل/أصلك؟
3)	Chou btechteghil?	شو بتشتغِل؟
4)	Kifak/ beik chi?	كيفَك/باك شي؟
5)	Baddak waslak?	بَدَّك وَصلَك؟
6)	Weyn sekin?	وَين ساكِن

EXERCISE NUMBER 3
Translate:

1. I want to see you tonight

_____

2. I wanted to eat

_____

3. I saw a brown dog yesterday

_____

4. They saw a doctor in the house

_____

5. You wanted to see the lawyer

_____

Answers:

1) badeh choufak el layleh بَدّي شوفَك الليلة
2) ken badeh ekol أنا كان بَدّي آكُل
3) mberiH chefet kalb beneh مبارِح شِفت كَلب بِنّي
4) Henneh chefo Hakim bel beit هِنّي شافوا حَكيم بالبَيت
5) ento kein badkoun tchoufo el mouHameh إنتو كان بَدكُن تشوفوا المُحامي

EXERCISE NUMBER 4

Translate:

1. Summer comes in June, winter comes in December, and fall comes in September.

_____

_____

2. I saw the doctor in July and I had a meeting with Jad in February.

_____

_____

3. In August, I want to go to the beach because the sun is very strong and it's very hot.

_____

_____

4. We go to the beach in July.

_____

5. My house will be fixed in March.

_____

6. Monday, Chadi had a meeting with the architect. He wanted to fix his apartment that is at the end of the street in a white short building. The architect told him that the project requires one month.

_____

_____

_____

7. I have school every Monday, Tuesday, and Friday.

_____

_____

8. The teacher gave me good grades on Friday and on Saturday I had a party.

_____

_____

Answers:

1) El sayf byeje bi Hzayran, el cheteh byeje bi kenoun el awwal wel kharif byeje bi 2ayloul.

الصَيف بيجي بِحزَيران، الشتي بيجي بِكانون الأوّل والخَريف بيجي بِأيلول

2) Chefet el Hakeem bi tammouz w ken 3ende maw3ad ma3 Jad bi chbat.

شِفت الحَكيم بِتَمّوز وكان عَندي مَوعَد مَع جاد بِشباط

3) Bi 2eib, bade rouH 3al ba7er li2ano el chames ktir awwiyeh w ktir chob.

بِأب، بَدّي روح على بَحر لأنّو الشَمس كتير قَوِيّة كتير شوب

4) Men rouH 3al baHer bi tammouz.

مِنروح على بَحر بِتَمّوز

5) beyteh raH yetzabat bi 2adar.

بَيتي رَح يتظَبَّط بِأدار

6) El tanein, Chadi ken 3endo maw3ad ma3 el mhandis. Ken bado yzabbet che2to yalle bi ekhir el cheri3 bi bineye bayda 2asireh. El mhandis 2allo eno el machrou3 bado chaher waHad.

التَنين، شادي كان عَندو مَوعَد مَع المهَندِس. كان بَدّو يظَبّط شِئتو يَلّي بِآخِر الشارع بِبِناية بَيضا قَصيرِة. المهَندِس قَلّو إنّو المَشروع بَدّو شَهر.

7) 3ende madraseh kel taneyn, taleta w jem3a.

عَندي مَدرَسِة كِلّ تَنين، تلاتا و جِمعَة.

8) el m3almeh 3atetne 3alemet mnee7a el jem3a wel sabet ken 3ende sahra.

المعَلِمة عَطتني عَلامات منيحَة الجِمعَة والسَبت كان عَندي سَهرَة.

EXERCISE NUMBER 5:

Translate:

M : Hi, How are you today ?

_____

T: I am good. How are you? How is your family?

_____

M: My family is good. My children will be going to school in September.

_____

T: How many kids do you have?

_____

M: I have 4, two boys and two girls. And you, do you have any kids?

_____

T: yes I have 1. He starts school in October.

M: How is your wife? What does she work?

T: My wife is good. She is an employee and she will have her own supermarket soon.

M: Wow! Will she have everything?

T: Yes, cheese, butter, jam, cucumbers, green beans, green peas, tomatoes, beetroots, apples, oranges, cherries, strawberries.... Almost everything!

Answer:
M: marHaba, kifak el yom?
T: mniH. enta kif? kif 3ayltak?
M: 3aylteh mniHa. wleideh raH ykouno rayHin 3al madrase bi ayloul.
T: kam walad 3andak?
M: 3andeh arb3a. sabyein w beintein. w enta 3andak wleid?
T: eh 3ande waHad. bi ballich madrase bi tecrhin el awwal.
M: kifa martak? chou btechtegil?
T: marteh mniHa. hiyyeh mwazaffeh w raH ysir 3anda supermarket la ela ariban.
M: waw! raH ykoun 3anda kel chi?
T: eh, jebne, zebdeh, mrabba, khyar, fasolya khadra, foul akhdar, banadoura, chmandar, teffeH, laymoun, karaz, fraise... ta2riban kel chi!

م: مَرحَبا، كيفَك اليوم؟
ت: منيح. إنتَ كيف؟ كيف عَيلتَك؟
م: عَيلتي منيحة. ولادي رَح يكونو رايحين على مَدرَسة بِأيلول
ت: كَم وَلَد عَندَك؟
م: عَندي أربعَة. صَبين و بنتين. و إنتَ عَندَك ولاد؟
ت: إي عَندي وَلَد. بِبَلِش مَدرَسة بِتشرين الأوَّل
م: كيفا مَرتَك؟ شو بتشتغِل؟
ت: مَرتي منيحَة. هِيّ موَظَّفة و رَح يصير عَندا سوبر ماركت لإلا قَريباً
م: واو! رَح يكون عَندا كِلّ شي؟
ت: إي، جِبنة/ زبدة، مرَبّة، خيار، فَصوليا خَضرا، فول أخضَر، بَندورَة، شمَندَر، تفّاح، لَيمون، كَرَز، فريز... تَقريباً كِلّ شي

CHAPTER 11: EXTRA

In this extra chapter, I will go in-depth into conjugating a verb in order to explain all the confusion that my students usually encounter.

Verb to watch: Hodir

(In order to know the root of the verb, you should put it in the masculine third person singular , in the past simple tense: houwweh Hodir)

PRESENT TENSE

The present simple indicates a general state:

I watch television every night: ana boHdar television kell leileh (present simple verbs always start with a "b" except the we pronoun: we watch neHna mnoHdar)

The present continuous is used for an action happening now: I am watching a series: ana 3am boHdar mousalsal

Present Simple Tense	Present Continuous
ana boHdar	3am boHdar
enta btoHdar	3am toHdar
enteh btoHdareh	3am toHdareh
houwweh byoHdar	3am yoHdar
hiyye btoHdar	3am toHdar
neHna mnoHdar	3am noHdar
ento btoHdaro	3am toHdaro
henneh byoHdaro	3am yoHdaro

Examples:

We usually watch the game together: 3adatan, neHna mnoHdar el moubarat sawa.

We are watching the game together: 3am noHdar el moubarat sawa.

PAST TENSE

Now that we covered the present tenses, let's move on to the past:

The past simple indicates an action that happened once in the past:
I traveled to Spain last year: ana sefaret 3a espania el seneh el madyeh.

The "used to + infinitive" tense indicates an action that used to take place in the past, but doesn't happen anymore:
I used to eat meat, but now I'm a vegetarian: ana kenet ekoul laHmeh, bas hala' soret nabeitiyeh.

Past simple	"used to + infinitive"
ana Hdoret	kenet oHdar
enta Hdoret	kenet toHdar
ente Hdorteh	kenteh toHdareh
houwe Hodir	ken yoHdar
hiyye Hodrit	kenit toHdar
neHna Hdorna	kenna noHdar
ento Hdorto	kento toHdaro
henneh Hodro	keno yoHdaro

Examples:

Last year, they watched the game together: el seneh el madyeh, Hodro el moubarat sawa.

Every year, they used to watch the game together: kell sene, keno yoHdaro el moubarat sawa.

FUTURE TENSE

The future tense, probably the easiest, indicates an action that will happen in the future. You only need to remove the "b" from the present simple, and add "raH" before the verb:

I will watch a performance tomorrow: ana raH oHdar 3ared bukra.

Future Tense
ana raH oHdar
enta raH toHdar
enteh raH toHdareh
houwweh raH yoHdar
hiyyeh raH toHdar
neHna raH noHdar
ento raH toHdaro
henneh raH yoHdaro

Examples:

What will you watch tomorrow: shou raH toHdar bokra?

The war will end soon: el Hareb raH tokhlas areeban.

STATE VERBS

There's also the state verbs (as I call them). They are the kind of verbs that are generally used to determinate a state like hungry, thirsty, tired, busy. They are all conjugated the same:
shou Hadir min afleim Scorsese?: Which Scorsese movies have you seen?

They also indicate an action:
They run after fame: henneh rekdeen wara el chohra

Pronouns	State Verb
ana/enta/houwweh	Hadir
ana/enteh/hiyyeh	Hadra
neHna/ento/henneh	Hadreen

More examples of state verbs:

We are hungry, do you have anything to eat? : neHna jou3anin, 3andkoun chi lal akeil?

She is very busy, she cannot reply to the phone: hiyyeh ktir machgouleh, ma fiya tred 3al telephone
I am going to the market in the afternoon, anyone wants anything? : ana rayiH 3al sou2 ba3ed el doher, Hadan baddo chi?

The old woman is very tired, we should take her to the hospital: el mara el kbeereh/khotyara kteer te3beneh, lezim nekheda 3al mestachfa

Who is going to the concert tomorrow night? : min rayiH 3al concert/ Hafleh el mousi2iyyeh boukra 3achiyyeh?

Who is coming with me to Tripoli? : min jeyeh ma3e 3a Trablous?

VERB TO SEE

Now that we have gone through these tenses, let's apply them by conjugating the verb "to see".

I see : ana bchouf/ 3am chouf / cheyfeh

Present simple:
I see the birds flying in September: ana bshouf el 3safir tayreen bi ayloul (tayreen is a state verb here).

Present contious:
I am seeing the birds from my window: ana 3am shouf el 3safeer min shebbeikeh.

State verb:
sheyif el baHer shou kbeer: Do you see how big the sea is? (from the famous Feyrouz song)

Past simple:
Who saw me in the interview?: meen sheifneh bil mou2abaleh?

Past continuous:
They used to see their father every day: henneh keino yshoufo bayyoun kell yom.

Future:
I will see your mom in Dubai and I will tell her hi from your side: raH shouf emmik bi dubai w sallemlik 3leya.

TIPS

Verbs and pronouns:

Another topic that always intrigues my students is that of the "indirect objects": how do we say "I saw her" in Lebanese? "I dreamt of you"? "I will tell them"? …

The answer is very easy! You simply add the pronoun you need to the verb, sometimes with little adjustments to make the verb sounds light…

For the third person, we add an "o" at the end if it's a masculine pronoun, and an "a" if it's feminine, and "oun" if it's plural:

I saw	shefet
I saw him	shefto
I saw her	shefta
I saw them	sheftoun

Tip: The "e" that is dropped from the end of "shefet" is only a matter of dialect. In some regions, you could say "sheft" instead of "shefet".

For the second person, we an "ak" if it's masculine, "ik" if it's feminine, and "koun" if it's plural:

I dreamt	Hlemet
I dreamt of you (masculine)	Hlemtak
I dreamt of you (feminine)	Hlemtik
I dreamt of you (plural)	Hlemtkoun

Examples:

I will write you a letter: raH ekteblik maktoub

I will travel with her to see you : rah sefir ma3a ta choufkoun

I will send you a song: rah eb3atlak / waddilak ghenniyeh

Sing us a song: ghannilna ghenniyeh

Can you get me water: fik tjebleh may?

Tell me your name: 2elleh chou esmak

Can you explain to him how to go to hamra: fikeh tfasrilo kif birouH 3al hamra?

Will you show her her room? : btfarjiya oudeta?

CONCLUSION

If you enjoyed the book, I would be very glad if you leave an honest review on the Amazon page of the book. The reviews will help me know what works and what doesn't so I can fix them in this book, as well as in subsequent volumes. To leave a review, please go to the Amazon page, scroll down to the end of the reviews, and click on "Write a customer review".

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Thank you for reading my book, I hope you found it to be helpful. In case you have any questions about the Lebanese Dialect, fell free to post it on either my Facebook page, or as a comment on my videos:

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ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Hiba Najem, has been teaching Lebanese Arabic online since 2011, and has fixed her method according to her students' needs and feedback. The social aspect of on-line teaching has helped her in developing her teaching into a very effective style.